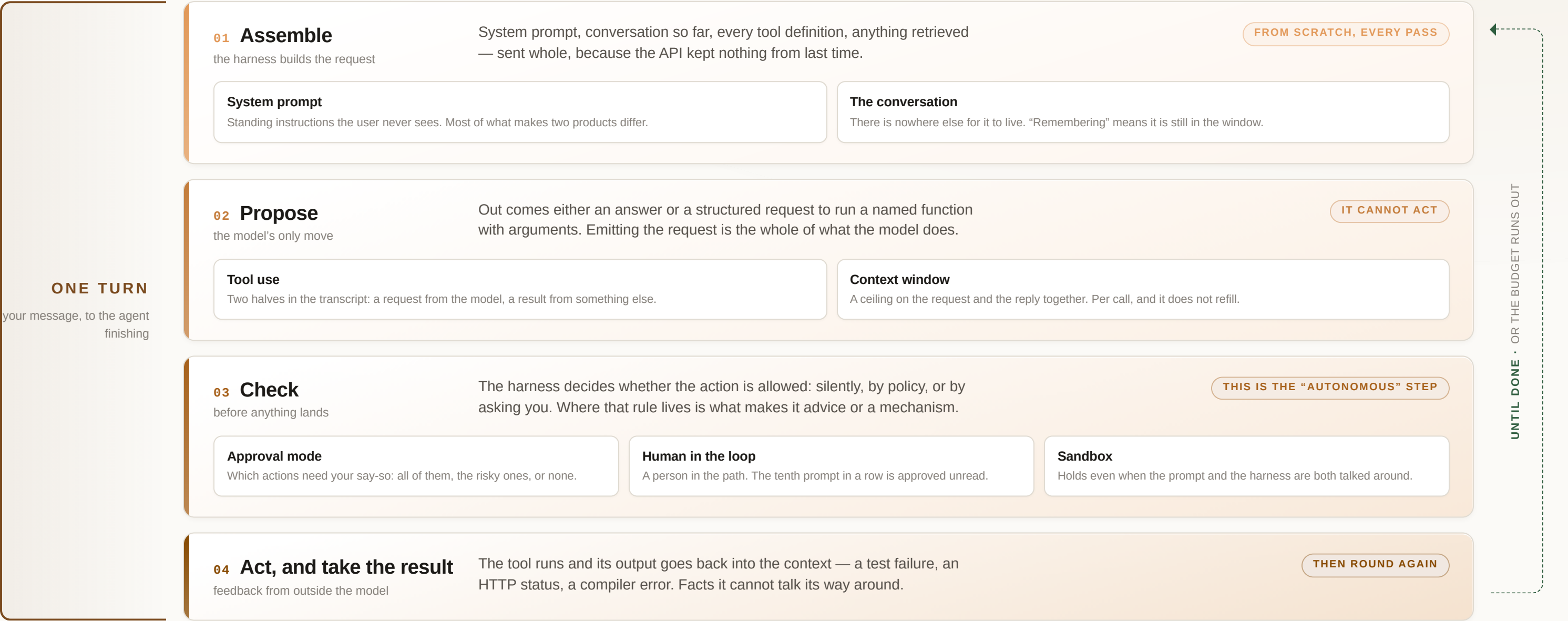


The agentic loop

What happens between your message and the answer, however many passes that takes.



WHAT DECIDES HOW FAR IT GOES

Autonomy level — Set per action class, not per product — usually free on reads, gated on writes, forbidden on a short list.

WHEN THE RUN GETS LONG

Compaction — Older turns swapped for a summary so the run keeps fitting. Lossy on purpose: what mattered only in the original wording is gone.

WHAT OUTLIVES IT

Session — One run, and everything scoped to it. A new session is a new window.

Long-term memory — Files the harness writes and reads back. Not a faculty of the model.

The loop is the product. A model call answers once; everything you recognise as an agent is this cycle, plus the rules about when it may act.